“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 11

The Description of the Beḍā-kīrtana Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 Performing a wildly leaping dance with His devotees in the temple of Śrī Jagannātha, Gauracandra, His limbs adorned with many ecstatic moods, by His own splendour plunged the whole world into a flood of prema.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 The next day Sārvabhauma said to the Lord, “If You grant me freedom from fear, I would like to make a request.”

4 The Lord said, “Speak without any fear. If it is proper I shall do it; if it is improper, I shall not.”

5 Sārvabhauma said, “King Pratāparudra is filled with longing; he wants to meet You.”

6 Covering His ears with His hands, the Lord uttered the name of Nārāyaṇa and said, “Sārvabhauma, why do you speak such improper words?

7 For Me, a renounced sannyāsī, to see a king is as bad as to see a woman: both are like swallowing poison.

8 “Alas, alas! For one who owns nothing in this world, who is turned toward the worship of the Lord and longs to cross to the far shore of the ocean of worldly existence, to look upon worldly people and women is worse even than drinking poison.” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.24)[3]

9 Sārvabhauma said, “Your words are true. But the king is a servant of Jagannātha and the best of devotees.”

10 The Lord said, “Still, a king is like a deadly black snake. Even the touch of a woman carved from wood can disturb the mind.[4]

11 “One should fear even the outward form of women and of worldly people; for as a snake disturbs the mind, so does even its likeness.” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.25)

12 Never bring such words to your lips again. If you speak of this once more, you will not see Me here any longer.”

13 Sārvabhauma went home in fear, and there he sat lost in anxious thought.

14 At that time Pratāparudra came to Puruṣottama, and with his ministers and friends the king went for darśana of Jagannātha.

15 Rāmānanda Rāya had come with the Gajapati king, and before anything else he went to the Lord and met Him with great joy.[5]

16 Rāya bowed down, and the Lord embraced him; the two of them wept in ecstatic love.

17 Seeing the Lord’s affectionate dealings with Rāya, all the devotees were filled with wonder.

18 Rāya said, “I conveyed Your order to the king, and in obedience to it he has released me from my worldly duties.[6]

19 I told him, ‘I can no longer attend to worldly affairs. If you permit, let me remain at the feet of Caitanya.’

20 Hearing Your name, the king was delighted. He rose from his throne and embraced me.

21 At Your name he was overwhelmed with love; taking my hand, he showed me special affection.

22 He said, ‘Keep drawing the salary you received before, and, free from care, worship the feet of Caitanya.’[7]

23 Then he said, ‘I am wretched, not fit to see Him. But whoever worships Him has made his life fruitful.

24 He, the son of the king of Vraja, is supremely merciful; in some birth He will surely let me see Him.’

25 I have not even a particle of the anguish of love for You that I saw in him.”

26 The Lord said, “You are the foremost of Kṛṣṇa’s devotees. Whoever loves you is fortunate.

27 The king has come to love you so much, and for this quality Kṛṣṇa will accept him as His own.

28 “O Pārtha, those who are devoted only to Me are not truly My devotees; but those who are devoted to My devotees I consider the best of My

devotees." (Ādi-purāṇa; also Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 2.6)[8]

29 "Reverence for My service, obeisance with the whole body, worship of My devotees greater than worship of Me, seeing Me in all living beings,[9]

30 the actions of the body done for My sake, speech that tells of My qualities, a mind offered to Me, and the giving up of all other desires." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.19.21–22)

31 "O goddess, of all forms of worship the worship of Viṣṇu is the highest; but higher still is the worship of those who belong to Him." (Padma-purāṇa, 6.253.176)[10]

32 "For one whose austerity is slight, it is hard to attain service to those who walk the path to Vaikuṇṭha — the devotees among whom Janārdana, the God of gods, is constantly glorified." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.7.20)[11]

33 Purī, Bhāratī Gosāñi, Svarūpa, Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Mukunda and all the other devotees were there.[12]

34 Rāya bowed at the feet of the four Gosāñis and met all the devotees, each as befitted him.

35 The Lord said, "Rāya, have you seen the lotus-eyed Lord?" Rāya said, "I am going now to see Him."

36 The Lord said, "Rāya, what have you done? Why did you come here first, without seeing the Lord?"

37 Rāya said, "The feet are the chariot and the heart is the charioteer. Wherever the heart drives, there the soul who rides in the chariot must go.[13]

38 What could I do? My mind brought me here; it gave no thought to seeing Jagannātha first."

39 The Lord said, "Go quickly and see Jagannātha; then go straight home and meet your family."[14]

40 Receiving the Lord's order, Rāya went to see Jagannātha. Who can understand the ways of Rāya's loving devotion?

41 Arriving at the holy Kṣetra, the king summoned Sārvabhauma. Bowing to him, he asked,

42 "Did you make my request at the Lord's feet?" Sārvabhauma said, "I tried very hard.

43 Still, He will not see a king. If I ask Him again, He will leave the Kṣetra."

44 Hearing this, the king was grieved at heart, and in his despair he began to speak.

45 "He has descended to deliver the sinful and the fallen; He delivered even Jagāi and Mādhāi.

46 He has descended with this vow: He will deliver the whole world, leaving out Pratāparudra alone.

47 "He looks with mercy even upon people of low birth, whom one is not supposed even to see — yet, alas, not upon me. Can it be that the Lord descended having resolved, 'I shall show mercy to everyone but him'?" (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.29)[15]

48 His vow is that He will not let me see Him; my vow is that without Him I shall give up my life.[16]

49 If I do not obtain the treasure of Mahāprabhu's mercy, what is my kingdom, what is my body? All of it is useless."

50 Hearing this, Sārvabhauma grew thoughtful; seeing the king's deep attachment, he was astonished.

51 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Your Majesty, do not despair. You will surely receive the Lord's grace.

52 He is subject to love, and your love is very deep; He will surely show His mercy to you.

53 Still, I shall tell you one means. Do as I say, and by this the Lord will see you.

54 On the day of the Ratha-yātrā the Lord, with all His devotees, will dance before the chariot, overwhelmed with love.

55 In that ecstasy of love He will enter the flower garden. At that time you must lay aside your royal dress and come alone.[17]

56 Reciting the five chapters on Kṛṣṇa's rāsa dance, go up to Him by yourself and clasp Mahāprabhu's feet.

57 He will not be aware of the outer world then; hearing Kṛṣṇa's name, He will embrace you, taking you for a Vaiṣṇava.

58 Today, when Rāmānanda Rāya spoke before the Lord of your love and qualities, the Lord's mind changed."

59 Hearing this, the Gajapati king was happy at heart, and he firmly resolved to follow this plan for meeting the Lord.

60 He asked the Bhaṭṭa when the Snāna-yātrā would be held, and he replied, “Three days remain until the festival.”

61 Having encouraged the king, the Bhaṭṭa went home. On the day of the Snāna-yātrā the Lord’s heart was full of joy.

62 Seeing the Snāna-yātrā, the Lord was very happy; but during Jagannātha’s *anavasara* He felt great sorrow.[18]

63 Distraught with separation in the mood of the gopīs, the Lord left everyone and went to Ālālanātha.[19]

64 Afterwards the devotees came to the Lord and told Him, “Devotees are coming from Gauḍa.”

65 Sārvabhauma brought the Lord back to Nīlācala, and then went and told the king, “The Lord has come.”

66 At that time Gopīnātha Ācārya came there. Blessing the king, he said, “Listen, Bhaṭṭācārya.[20]

67 Two hundred Vaiṣṇavas are coming from Gauḍa — devotees of Mahāprabhu, every one of them a mahā-bhāgavata.[21]

68 They have all arrived at the Narendra lake. Lodging must be found for all of them, and prasāda provided.”[22]

69 The king said, “I shall give the order to the paḍichā, and he will provide lodging and whatever else is needed.[23]

70 Bhaṭṭācārya, show me one by one all of Mahāprabhu's associates who have come from Gauḍa."

71 The Bhaṭṭa said, "Go up onto the roof of the palace. Gopīnātha knows them all; he will point them out to you.

72 I do not know any of them, though I would like to. Gopīnātha Ācārya will introduce them all."

73 Saying this, the three of them climbed onto the roof of the palace, and at that moment the Vaiṣṇavas drew near.

74 Svarūpa Dāmodara and Govinda went with garlands and prasāda to where the Vaiṣṇavas were.

75 Mahāprabhu had sent these two ahead. The king said, "Who are these two? Tell me."

76 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "This is Svarūpa Dāmodara. He is Mahāprabhu's second body.

77 The second is Govinda, His servant. Through these two the Lord has sent garlands, to show His respect."

78 First Svarūpa placed a garland on Advaita; then Govinda brought a second garland and gave it to him.

79 Then Govinda fell flat in obeisance before the Ācārya. Not knowing him, the Ācārya asked Dāmodara who he was.

80 Dāmodara said, "His name is Govinda. He was the servant of Īśvara Purī, and he is a man of great virtue.

81 Purī ordered him to serve the Lord, and so the Lord has kept him near Him.”

82 The king said, “The one to whom these two gave garlands has a wonderful effulgence — He is a great soul. Tell me, who is He?”

83 The Ācārya said, “His name is Advaita Ācārya. Mahāprabhu Himself respects Him, and everyone bows to Him.[24]

84 This is Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, that is Vakreśvara Paṇḍita; that is Vidyānidhi Ācārya, and this is Gadādhara Paṇḍita.[25]

85 This is Ācāryaratna, that is Purandara Paṇḍita; this is Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, that is Śaṅkara Paṇḍita.[26]

86 This is Murāri Gupta, this is Paṇḍita Nārāyaṇa, and this is Haridāsa Ṭhākura, who purifies the whole world.

87 This is Hari Bhaṭṭa, this is Śrī Nṛsiṁhānanda; this is Vāsudeva Datta, and this is Śivānanda.

88 Here are Govinda, Mādhava Ghoṣa and Vāsu Ghoṣa — three brothers whose kīrtana delights the Lord.[27]

89 This is Rāghava Paṇḍita, and this is Nandana Ācārya; this is Śrīmān Paṇḍita, and here are Śrīkānta and Nārāyaṇa.

90 Look, this is Śuklāmbara; here are Śrīdhara and Vijaya. This is Vallabha Sena, and here are Puruṣottama and Sañjaya.

91 This is Satyarāja Khān of Kulīna-grāma; and see, Rāmānanda and all the others are here.

92 Here are Mukunda dāsa, Narahari and Śrī Raghunandana, and Cirañjīva and Sulocana — residents of Khaṇḍa.

93 How many shall I name? All the people you see here are Caitanya's own associates, and Caitanya is their very life."

94 The king said, "Seeing them, I am filled with wonder. Never have I seen Vaiṣṇavas with such effulgence.

95 They are all as radiant as millions of suns. Never have I seen such sweet kīrtana.

96 Such love, such dancing, such chanting of Hari's name I have never seen or heard anywhere."

97 The Bhaṭṭācārya spoke these sweet words: "This saṅkīrtana of love is Caitanya's creation.[28]

98 Caitanya has descended to preach dharma, and in the age of Kali the dharma is the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's names.

99 One who worships Him with the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana is truly intelligent; all others are people whose minds the age of Kali has struck down.[29]

100 "With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)[30]

101 The king said, “By the evidence of scripture Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa. Why, then, are the scholars all averse to Him?”

102 The Bhaṭṭa said, “Only one who has received a particle of His mercy can accept Him as Kṛṣṇa.

103 One who does not have His mercy, however learned he may be, will not accept Him as the Supreme Lord, even when he sees Him and hears of Him.[31]

104 “O Lord, only one who is favoured with even a trace of the grace of Your two lotus feet can know the truth of Your greatness as Bhagavān; no one else can know it, however long he may search.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.29)[32]

105 The king said, “Why have they all gone hurrying to Caitanya’s residence without first seeing Jagannātha?”

106 The Bhaṭṭa said, “This is the natural way of love: their hearts long to meet Mahāprabhu.

107 First they will all meet Him; then they will go with Him to see Jagannātha.”

108 The king said, “Vāṇīnātha, the son of Bhavānanda, is carrying prasāda, and five or seven men are going with him.

109 He has gone to Mahāprabhu’s residence. Why is so much mahā-prasāda needed? Tell me.”

110 The Bhaṭṭa said, “Knowing that the devotees have arrived, they are carrying prasāda to them at the Lord’s hint.”

111 The king said, “Fasting and shaving the head are the rules for a holy place. Why will they eat and drink without observing them?”[33]

112 The Bhaṭṭa said, “What you speak of is the dharma of rules. On this path of spontaneous love there is a subtler, inner meaning of dharma.[34]

113 Shaving and fasting are the Lord’s indirect command; to eat prasāda is the Lord’s direct command.[35]

114 One should fast where there is no mahā-prasāda. When the Lord has ordered it, to reject prasāda is an offence.

115 Above all, Mahāprabhu Himself serves the prasāda. Why would they give up such a gain and fast?

116 Once the Lord brought me prasāda, and early in the morning, still sitting on my bed, I ate it.[36]

117 One whom He favours and inspires from within takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa and gives up the dharma of the Vedas and of the world.

118 “When the Lord, on whom the heart meditates, bestows His favour on someone, that person gives up his mind’s fixed attachment to worldly affairs and to Vedic ritual.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 4.29.46)[37]

119 Then the king came down from the palace roof and summoned Kāśī Miśra and the paḍichā-pātra.[38]

120–121 Pratāparudra ordered those two to arrange comfortable lodging and ample prasāda for all the Lord’s associates who had come to Him, and to see that they could have darśana of Jagannātha freely, without any hindrance.

122 “Both of you must carefully carry out the Lord’s orders. And even where there is no order, understand His wishes from His hints and act on them.”[39]

123 With these words the king dismissed the two of them, and Sārvabhauma came to watch the Vaiṣṇavas meet the Lord.

124 Gopīnātha Ācārya and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya both watched from a distance as the Lord met the Vaiṣṇavas.

125 Leaving the Lion Gate on their right, all the Vaiṣṇavas made their way along the road to Kāśī Miśra’s house.

126 At that moment Mahāprabhu came with His own companions and met the Vaiṣṇavas on the road with great delight.

127 Advaita bowed at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord embraced the Ācārya with love.

128 Both were utterly overcome by the bliss of love; then, mindful of the occasion, the Lord composed Himself a little.

129 Śrīvāsa and the others bowed at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord embraced each of them with love.

130 He greeted all the devotees one by one and took them all inside.

131 Miśra’s house was small, yet it held the countless Vaiṣṇavas.[40]

132 The Lord seated them all close to Himself, and with His own hand He gave everyone garlands and sandal paste.

133 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya came to where Mahāprabhu was and greeted everyone as befitted each.

134 The Lord spoke sweetly to Advaita: “Today, with Your coming, I am complete.”

135–136 Advaita said, “This is the Lord’s nature: although He is complete in Himself and full of all majesty, still He finds joyful delight in the company of His devotees, and with them He eternally enjoys pastimes of every kind.”[41]

137 The Lord was delighted to see Vāsudeva, and, laying His hand on him, He said:

138 “Though Mukunda has been with Me since childhood, I feel greater joy in seeing you.”

139 Vāsu said, “Mukunda obtained Your company; he obtained Your feet — that was his second birth.[42]

140 Though he is younger, Mukunda has now become my elder. He is the recipient of Your mercy, and so he excels in every quality.”

141 The Lord spoke again: “I have brought two books from the South for you.[43]

142 Svarūpa has them; copy them for yourself.” Vāsudeva was delighted to receive the books.

143 Every one of the Vaiṣṇavas made a copy for himself, and so, little by little, the two books spread everywhere.

144 With great affection the Lord said to Śrīvāsa and his brothers, “I have been bought by you four brothers.”

145 Śrīvāsa replied, “Why do You say the opposite? At the price of Your mercy You have bought us four brothers.”

146 Seeing Śaṅkara, the Lord said to Dāmodara, “My love for you is full of reverence,

147 but for Śaṅkara I have pure, unmixed love. So keep Śaṅkara with you.”

148 Dāmodara said, “Śaṅkara is younger than I, but now, by Your mercy, he has become my elder brother.”

149 The Lord said to Śivānanda, “I have long known of your deep attachment to Me.”

150 Hearing this, Śivānanda Sena was overwhelmed with love; he fell flat like a rod before the Lord and recited this verse:

151 “O Infinite One, for so long I was sinking in the ocean of worldly existence, and now I have found You, like the shore. And You too, O Lord, have now found in me the most fitting vessel for Your mercy.” (Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 8.42; Stotra-ratna, 26)[44]

152 At first Murāri Gupta did not come to see the Lord; he lay outside, fallen prostrate.

153 Not seeing Murāri, the Lord searched for him, and many people ran to fetch him.

154 Holding two bunches of grass between his teeth, Murāri came before Mahāprabhu, overcome with humility.

155 Seeing Murāri, the Lord came forward to meet him, but Murāri drew back and began to say,

156 “Do not touch me, O Lord, for I am a wretch. This body is not fit for You to touch.”

157 The Lord said, “Murāri, restrain your humility. When I see such humility, My heart is torn apart.”

158 Saying this, the Lord embraced him, seated him beside Himself and wiped his body clean with His own hands.[45]

159–160 Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Gaṅgādāsa, Hari Bhaṭṭa and Ācārya Purandara — the Lord sang the virtues of each of them, embraced them again and again, and so honoured them.[46]

161 Having honoured them all, the Lord was overjoyed. But not seeing Haridāsa, He asked, “Where is Haridāsa?”

162 Haridāsa, keeping far away and not looking upon the Lord, lay prostrate at the edge of the main road.[47]

163 He had come to the meeting place but did not approach the Lord; he remained lying far off at the edge of the main road.

164 All the devotees ran to fetch Haridāsa. “The Lord wants to meet you,” they said. “Come quickly!”

165 Haridāsa said, “I am low-born and worthless. I have no right to go near the temple.

166 If I can get a secluded place within the garden, I will stay there alone and pass my days.[48]

167 There I shall not come into contact with the servants of Jagannātha. To stay there is my desire."

168 People went and told the Lord what he had said, and hearing it the Lord was very happy at heart.

169 At that time Kāśī Miśra and the paḍichā, the temple superintendent, came and bowed at the Lord's feet.

170 Seeing all the Vaiṣṇavas, they were very happy, and they greeted everyone joyfully, as befitted each.

171 At the Lord's feet the two of them made their request: "Give us leave to look after the Vaiṣṇavas.

172 We have arranged lodgings for everyone, and we will provide mahā-prasāda for all."

173 The Lord said, "Gopīnātha, take the Vaiṣṇavas with you, and settle them in wherever the lodgings are pointed out to you.

174 Give the mahā-prasāda to Vāṇīnātha; he will provide for all the Vaiṣṇavas.

175 Near Me, in this flower garden, there is a single room in a very secluded spot.[49]

176 Give that room to Me — I have need of it. Sitting there in seclusion, I shall absorb Myself in remembrance."

177 Miśra said, “All is Yours — why do You ask? Take whatever You wish, as You please.

178 We two are Your servants, ready to do Your bidding. Be merciful and command whatever You wish.”

179 So saying, the two took their leave, taking Gopīnātha and Vāṇīnātha with them.

180 They showed Gopīnātha all the lodgings and gave Vāṇīnātha prasāda in abundance.

181 Vāṇīnātha returned with a great quantity of prasāda and cakes, and Gopīnātha came back after making the lodgings ready.

182 Mahāprabhu said, “Listen, all you Vaiṣṇavas: go now, each of you, to your own lodgings.

183 Bathe in the sea and take darśana of the temple’s pinnacle; then come back, for today you will take your meal here.”[50]

184 Bowing to the Lord, they all went off to their lodgings, and Gopīnātha Ācārya gave everyone a place to stay.

185 Then Mahāprabhu came to meet Haridāsa, and found him lovingly singing the holy Name.

186 Seeing the Lord, he fell prostrate at His feet, and the Lord raised him up and embraced him.

187 Both of them wept, absorbed in love: the servant overcome by the master’s virtues, and the master by the servant’s.[51]

188 Haridāsa said, “O Lord, do not touch me. I am low, untouchable, the most fallen of all.”

189 The Lord said, “I touch you to purify Myself, for I have none of your pure dharma.

190 At every moment you bathe in all the holy places; at every moment you perform sacrifice, austerity and charity.

191 You study the Vedas without cease, and you are far more purifying than any brāhmaṇa or sannyāsī.

192 “Oh, how wonderful! Even a dog-eater is worthy of the highest honour if Your name is on the tip of his tongue. Those who utter Your name have already performed austerities and offered sacrifices; they have bathed in all the holy waters, they are truly noble, and they have studied the Vedas.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.7)[52]

193 So saying, He took him to the flower garden and gave him a dwelling in a very secluded spot.[53]

194 “Stay here and sing the holy Name. I shall come and meet you every day.

195 When you see the cakra on the temple, offer your obeisance. Your prasāda will be brought to you here.”[54]

196 Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara and Mukunda all met Haridāsa and rejoiced.[55]

197 After bathing in the sea, the Lord returned to His residence, and Advaita and the others went to bathe in the ocean.

198 On their way back they took darśana of the pinnacle of Jagannātha's temple and came to the Lord's residence to eat.

199 The Lord seated everyone in proper order, and Gaurahari served them with His own sacred hand.[56]

200 The Lord's hand could not give just a little: He put enough for two or three on every single leaf.

201 Since the Lord had not eaten, no one would eat: all the devotees sat waiting with their hands held back from the food.

202 Svarūpa Gosāñi made his request to the Lord: "Unless You sit down, no one will eat.

203 Gopīnātha Ācārya has invited all the sannyāsīs who stay with You.

204 The Ācārya has come, bringing prasāda for their meal, and Purī and Bhāratī are waiting for You.

205 Sit down with Nityānanda and take Your meal; I will serve the Vaiṣṇavas."

206 Then the Lord put prasāda into Govinda's hands and carefully sent it to Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

207 He Himself sat down with all the sannyāsīs, and the Ācārya served them with delight.

208 Svarūpa, Dāmodara and Jagadānanda — these three joyfully served the Vaiṣṇavas.[57]

209 Happily they feasted on all kinds of cakes and sweet drinks, and every now and then, in their delight, they called out “Hari!”[58]

210 When the meal was finished, they rinsed their mouths, and the Lord adorned everyone with garlands and sandal paste.

211 Everyone went to their own lodgings to rest, and in the evening they came and met the Lord again.

212 Just then Rāmānanda arrived at the Lord’s residence, and the Lord introduced him to all the Vaiṣṇavas.

213 Taking everyone with Him, the Lord went to the temple of Jagannātha, and there the great Lord began the kīrtana.

214 During the evening worship the son of Śacī danced. When the incense and lamps were lit, He began the saṅkīrtana.[59]

215 The paḍichā came and gave everyone garlands and sandal paste. On all four sides, four groups were singing kīrtana.[60]

216 Eight mṛdaṅgas and thirty-two pairs of karatālas resounded; everyone called out the name of Hari, crying, “Wonderful! Wonderful!”

217 The supremely auspicious sound of the kīrtana arose; it filled the fourteen worlds and pierced the shell of the universe.

218 As the kīrtana began, love surged up and overflowed, and the people of Nīlācala came running.

219 Seeing the kīrtana, everyone was struck with wonder: “Never have we seen such transformations of love!”

220 Then the Lord went dancing round Jagannātha's temple in reverent circumambulation.

221 The four groups sang in front of Him and behind, and whenever He fell, Nityānanda Rāya caught Him.

222 Tears, hair standing on end, trembling, sweat and deep roars — seeing these transformations of love, the people were amazed.[61]

223 The tears from His eyes shot out more forcefully than water from a syringe, and the people all around were bathed in them.[62]

224 For some time Mahāprabhu danced the *beḍā-nṛtya*, the dance around the temple; then, staying behind it, He went on with the kīrtana.[63]

225 On all four sides the four groups sang loudly, and in their midst Gaura Rāya danced the vigorous *tāṇḍava* dance.

226 After dancing for a long time, the Lord became still, and then He told four great souls to dance.

227 In one group Nityānanda Rāya danced, and in another Advaita Ācārya danced.

228 In another group Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced, and in yet another, Śrīvāsa.

229 Mahāprabhu stood in the middle watching them, and there a wonder of His divine majesty appeared.[64]

230 All those dancing and singing on the four sides said, "The Lord is looking at me!"

231 The Lord wanted to see the dancing of all four, and that desire led Him to display His majesty.

232 Seeing the absorption of His gaze, each knew only that He was looking at him; how He could be looking in all four directions at once, no one knew.

233 It was just as when Kṛṣṇa sat in the midst of His friends at the meal on the riverbank, and each of them said, "He is looking at me!"[65]

234 Whoever came near Him while dancing, Mahāprabhu embraced him tightly.

235 Seeing the great dancing, the great love and the great saṅkīrtana, the people of Nīlācala were swept away in the rapture of love.

236 When the Gajapati king heard of the glory of the kīrtana, he climbed onto the roof of his palace and watched with his attendants.

237 Seeing the kīrtana, the king was struck with wonder, and his eagerness to meet the Lord grew boundless.

238 When the kīrtana was over, the Lord watched the offering of flowers to Jagannātha and then returned to His lodging with all the Vaiṣṇavas.

239 The paḍichā brought prasāda in abundance, and the Lord shared it out among everyone.

240 Then He let everyone go to take their rest. Such are the pastimes of the son of Śacī.

241 For as long as they all stayed with Mahāprabhu, they spent every day like this in the joy of kīrtana.

242 Thus I have described the Lord’s pastimes of kīrtana. Whoever hears of them becomes a servant of Caitanya.

243 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “The dancing Gaura plunges the world into a flood of prema.” ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: what is forbidden is to look upon worldly people and women with the eyes of an enjoyer, as objects of enjoyment. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the same way, the mere sight of a king, even if he is the best of devotees, may give rise to an anartha in one who is renounced. ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “Gajapati” (“lord of elephants”) was the title of the emperors of Orissa, as other kings bore the titles “chatrapati”, “narapati” or “aśvapati”. ↩
6. The edition reads «tomāra ājñāya» (“by Your order”); the older text has «icchāya» (“by Your wish”). *Anubhāṣya*: see Madhya 8.297–298; following Mahāprabhu’s wish, the king publicly released Rāmānanda from worldly affairs — he gave him leave from his post. ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Rāmānanda had drawn this salary as governor of southern Kaliṅga; though released from service, he would go on receiving it. ↩
8. Heading in the edition: “The devotee of the devotee is the true devotee of Bhagavān” (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, 2.6; the words of the *Ādi-purāṇa*). ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Bhagavān to Uddhava on bhakti-yoga. ↩
10. Heading in the edition: “The worship of the Vaiṣṇava is higher than the worship of Viṣṇu, the Lord of all lords” (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, 2.4; the words of Śiva to Pārvatī in the *Padma-purāṇa*). *Anubhāṣya*: “those who belong to Him” are Kṛṣṇa’s associates in every rasa — in mādhurya Śrī Rūpa, Vārṣabhānavī and others, in vātsalya Nanda and Yaśodā, in sakhya Śrīdāmā and Subala, in dāsya Citraka and others. ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Vidura to Maitreya. Only by serving great souls does one hear hari-kathā; from it love for Hari is born, and with it even concern for the body falls away. ↩

12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Purī is Paramānanda Purī, Bhāratī is Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Svarūpa is Svarūpa Dāmodara, Nityānanda is Nityānanda Prabhu — the four Gosāñis of the next verse. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: the soul is like the rider in a chariot, the feet are the chariot, and the mind is the charioteer; wherever the mind drives, there the soul goes. Compare Kaṭha Upaniṣad 1.3.3–6, 9: the self is the rider, the body the chariot, the intelligence the charioteer and the mind the reins. ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: having seen Jagannātha, go straight home and meet your relatives. ↩
15. The words of Pratāparudra to Sārvabhauma; the reference follows the heading in the edition (act 8, verse 29). ↩
16. Heading in the edition: “The king resolves to give up his life if he does not receive the Lord’s mercy.” ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: the flower garden is at Guṇḍicā. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: after the Snāna-yātrā the painting of Śrī Jagannātha’s body (*aṅga-rāga*) is renewed, and for that time the Deity stays apart, hidden from those who come for darśana; this period is called *anavasara*. ↩
19. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: during the *anavasara* the Lord could not see Jagannātha and, beside Himself in separation from Kṛṣṇa, went to Ālālanātha and stayed there. ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: on Gopīnātha Ācārya see Ādi 10.130. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: the mahā-bhāgavatas are *niṣkiñcanas* above *varṇāśrama*, *paramahaṁsas* whose only shelter is Kṛṣṇa; as Śrī Narottama Ṭhākura writes in his *Prārthanā*, “One who regards the associates of Gaurāṅga as eternally perfect goes to the son of the king of Vraja.” ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Narendra is the pond where the Candana-yātrā festival is held; even today Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas coming to Puruṣottama wash their hands and feet in its water before going to the temple. ↩
23. The *paḍichā* is the superintendent of the temple (see verse 119). ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “the Ācārya said” — Gopīnātha Ācārya said. ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: Vidyānidhi Ācārya (Ācāryanidhi) is Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi; see the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 10.14. ↩
26. The heading in the edition gives Ācāryaratna’s name — Candraśekhara. ↩
27. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Govinda Ghoṣa was born in a Kāyastha family of Uttara-rāḍha; he is called Ghoṣa Ṭhākura, and to this day a fair is held in his name at Agradvīpa, near Katwa. Vāsu Ghoṣa composed many songs about Mahāprabhu, which hold the first place among the songs of the mahājanas. ↩
28. Heading in the edition: “Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the founder of saṅkīrtana.” ↩

29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one who worships Kṛṣṇa Caitanya with the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana is truly intelligent; those who do not are *kali-hata* — Kali has destroyed their intelligence. *Anubhāṣya*: only the word of a pure devotee who sings of Kṛṣṇa awakens another *jīva* to service; the “kīrtana” and dancing of one devoted to the world are rooted in unbelief and remain a passing excitement. ↩
30. The same verse as Ādi 3.51 and Madhya 6.103; translation as there. ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: on verses 102–103 see Madhya 6.82–87. ↩
32. The same verse as Madhya 6.84; translation as there. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: one who goes on pilgrimage observes restraint on the day before and fasts on the next day to destroy sins, and shaves the head to destroy the sins that reside there; the king asks why the devotees set aside these rules and eat. ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: what the king speaks of is *vaidhi-dharma*, the path of rules. ↩
35. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: shaving and fasting Bhagavān has ordered indirectly, through the sages in the śāstras; but to eat prasāda He has ordered Himself. ↩
36. Compare Madhya 6.216–226. ↩
37. *Anubhāṣya*: the words of Nārada Gosvāmī to King Prācīnabarhi after the story of Purañjana: without Bhagavān’s mercy no one — not Brahmā, Rudra, the Kumāras, nor Nārada himself — attained knowledge of Him. *Ātma-bhāvitaḥ* — He on whom the heart meditates, whom one worships there, and who reveals Himself there. ↩
38. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the word *paḍichā* comes from *parīkṣā*, “examination”; the paḍichā is the superintendent of the temple. ↩
39. Heading in the edition: “It is best to serve according to the hint of the one served.” *Anubhāṣya*: so that the devotees should not be inconvenienced in anything, the two were to understand Mahāprabhu’s hint even without an explicit order and do at once whatever was needed. ↩
40. Heading in the edition: “Though Kāśī Miśra’s house is small, all the devotees gather in it.” ↩
41. Heading in the edition: “Advaita describes the nature of Īśvara — His love for His devotees.” ↩
42. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mukunda took shelter at the Lord’s feet before Vāsudeva did, so his spiritual birth came first, and Vāsudeva became the “younger”. ↩
43. *Anubhāṣya*: the two books are the *Śrī Brahma-saṁhitā* and the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*. ↩

44. Heading in the edition: the verse of the *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* (8.42), the twenty-sixth verse of the hymn of Yāmunācārya (Āḷavandār). *Anubhāṣya*: *anuttamam pātram* — a vessel of mercy than which there is none better. ↩
45. The first line is the same as in Madhya 10.60; translated as there. Heading in the edition: “Bhagavān serves His devotee.” ↩
46. The heading in the edition names Ācāryaratna as Candraśekhara and Vidyānidhi as Puṇḍarīka: “The Lord praises and embraces Candraśekhara, Puṇḍarīka, Gadādhara and others.” ↩
47. Reading of the editions: the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition has *gosāñe nā dekhiyā*, “not seeing the Lord”, as of Murāri in verse 152; another edition, without *nā*, reads “seeing the Lord from afar”. The *Anubhāṣya* heads the verse: “Out of humility Ṭhākura Haridāsa keeps at a distance.” ↩
48. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ṭoṭā* — a garden. ↩
49. *Anubhāṣya*: this place is now known as the “Siddha-bakula Maṭha”. ↩
50. Heading in the edition: “The Lord invites all the devotees, after bathing, to see the spire of the temple and come to honour prasāda.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *cūḍā* — the spire of Jagannātha’s temple. ↩
51. Heading in the edition: “Remembering each other’s qualities, both the devotee and Bhagavān lose themselves in love.” ↩
52. *Anubhāṣya*: Devahūti, praising Lord Kapila, glorifies His devotee: one born in a low family who has the Name on his tongue is the best, for by the law of initiation he is a brāhmaṇa; those who chant the Name are above ascetics, have offered homa, bathed in every tīrtha, are noble in conduct (*āryāḥ*) and have studied the Vedas with their limbs. ↩
53. Heading in the edition: “The Lord gives Ṭhākura Haridāsa a place in ‘Siddha-bakula’.” ↩
54. *Anubhāṣya*: following the worldly rules of smṛti, Haridāsa Ṭhākura considered himself unfit to enter the temple and see Śrī Jagannātha; knowing this, Mahāprabhu arranged that he should bow from afar to the Sudarśana-cakra on top of the temple spire, and told him that mahā-prasāda would be brought to him here, in Siddha-bakula. ↩
55. The first line is the same as in Madhya 1.100. ↩
56. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “in proper order” — seating each one where he ought to sit, one after another. ↩
57. Heading in the edition: “Svarūpa and the other two serve prasāda to all the devotees.” ↩

58. *Anubhāṣya*: at that time it was the custom in the pure sampradāya to call out the name of Hari while honouring prasāda. ↩
59. Reading of the editions: another edition has here and in 215 “Seeing the evening incense offering, He began the saṅkīrtana; the paḍichā came and gave everyone garlands and sandal paste. On all four sides four groups sang kīrtana, and in the middle the Lord, the son of Śacī, danced”; the translation follows the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition, and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* cites the other reading as a variant. ↩
60. Reading of the editions — see the note to verse 214. ↩
61. Heading in the edition: “The eight sāttvika transformations of the Lord.” ↩
62. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the people all around bathe in the streams of His tears. ↩
63. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *beḍā-nṛtya* — the dance around the temple (*beḍā* — “around”); hence the title of the chapter, “Beḍā-kīrtana”. The heading in the edition before verse 220: “The ‘beḍā-nṛtya’ kīrtana, that is, kīrtana while circling the temple.” ↩
64. Heading in the edition: “The Lord stays in the midst of the kīrtana and, to see the dance of all four, displays His divine majesty.” ↩
65. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when Śrī Kṛṣṇa took His meal on the riverbank in Vraja (*pulina-bhojana*), the cowherd boys sat around Him, and each saw that Kṛṣṇa was eating with His face turned towards him; so too, as Mahāprabhu danced, each devotee around Him saw His face before him. This is also a display of the Lord’s majesty (*aiśvarya*). ↩